



10.1. Python: Common Methods in Lists

"Simple is better than complex"

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Lists become truly powerful when we start using their built-in methods. These methods allow us to manipulate data efficiently without manually rewriting the entire list.

In real-world programming, especially in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence, we constantly:

- Add new data
- Remove unnecessary values
- Sort information
- Reverse sequences
- Count occurrences
- Process numerical values

Python provides many built-in methods that make these operations simple and efficient.

Common List Methods

Method	Description
<code>list.append(x)</code>	Adds one element to the end
<code>list.clear()</code>	Removes all elements
<code>list.extend(iterable)</code>	Adds multiple elements
<code>list.insert(i, x)</code>	Inserts element at index
<code>list.pop(i)</code>	Removes element using index
<code>list.remove(x)</code>	Removes first occurrence
<code>list.reverse()</code>	Reverses the list
<code>list.sort()</code>	Sorts the list
<code>list.count(x)</code>	Counts occurrences
<code>len(list)</code>	Returns list length
<code>sum(list)</code>	Returns sum of elements
<code>max(list)</code>	Returns maximum value
<code>min(list)</code>	Returns minimum value

append()

The `append()` method adds a single element to the end of the list.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google']
list1.append('Amazon')

print(list1)
```

['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google', 'Amazon']

This is one of the most commonly used methods in Python.

extend()

The `extend()` method adds multiple elements from another iterable into the list.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google']
list1.extend(['Tesla', 'Facebook'])

print(list1)
```

['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google', 'Tesla', 'Facebook']

Difference between `append()` and `extend()`:

- `append()` adds ONE element
- `extend()` adds MULTIPLE elements

insert()

The `insert()` method inserts an element at a specific index.

Syntax:

```
list.insert(index, value)
```

Example:

```
list2 = [12, 34, 56, 78, 99]
list2.insert(2, 45)

print(list2)
```

[12, 34, 45, 56, 78, 99]

Notice that: 45 is inserted at index 2 . Existing elements shift to the right

pop()

The `pop()` method removes an element based on its index. It also returns the removed value.

```
list2 = [12, 34, 45, 56, 78, 99]

removed_item = list2.pop(3)

print(removed_item)
print(list2)
```

56

[12, 34, 45, 78, 99]

This is useful when we need to remove an element and also store the removed value

remove()

The `remove()` method removes the first occurrence of a value.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google', 'Tesla', 'Facebook']
list1.remove('Tesla')

print(list1)
```

['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google', 'Facebook']

Important: `remove()` removes by VALUE, while `pop()` removes by INDEX

reverse()

The `reverse()` method reverses the list directly.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google']
list1.reverse()

print(list1)
```

['Google', 'Microsoft', 'Apple']

sort()

The `sort()` method sorts the list in ascending order.

```
list2 = [12, 34, 56, 78, 99]
list2.sort()

print(list2)
```

[12, 34, 56, 78, 99]

Another example:

```
numbers = [78, 12, 99, 34, 56]
numbers.sort()

print(numbers)
```

[12, 34, 56, 78, 99]

count()

The `count()` method counts how many times an element appears in the list.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Google', 'Microsoft', 'Google']
count_google = list1.count('Google')

print(count_google)
```

2

len()

The `len()` function returns the number of elements in the list.

```
list2 = [12, 34, 56, 78, 99]
print(len(list2))
```

5

sum()

The `sum()` function calculates the total sum of numerical elements.

Example:

```
list2 = [12, 34, 56, 78, 99]
print(sum(list2))
```

279

max() and min()

The `max()` function returns the largest value. The `min()` function returns the smallest value.

```
list2 = [12, 34, 56, 78, 99]
print(max(list2))
print(min(list2))
```

99

12

clear()

The `clear()` method removes all elements from the list.

```
list1 = ['Apple', 'Microsoft', 'Google']
list1.clear()

print(list1)
```

[]

The list still exists, but it becomes empty.

Summary

List methods are extremely important because they allow us to manipulate data efficiently.

As we move deeper into programming, we will constantly use these operations for:

- Dataset preprocessing
- AI feature handling
- Sorting information
- Data cleaning
- Numerical analysis
- Managing large collections of data

So even though these methods may seem small individually... together, they become some of the most powerful tools in Python programming.

References

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/python/list-methods-python/>

<https://www.codecademy.com/learn/introduction-to-python-for-finance/modules/learn-python3-lists/cheatsheet>

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`</>` [10.2. Python: List Comprehension](#)